

Formal Request for Review: Performance Management Process and Handling of Confidential Disclosure

From: Cory Shepherd

coryshepherd1@hotmail.com

To: Cory Shepherd

cory.shepherd@health.qld.gov.au

Sent: Saturday 4 October 2025 at 12:43

To: Ms. Jacquie Roberts, A/Director, HR Business
Partnering

From: Cory Shepherd

Date: October 4th, 2025

Dear Ms. Roberts,

I am writing to formally request your urgent professional intervention regarding a performance improvement plan initiated by my Director, Mr. Scott Hughes, on September 10, 2025. This action was taken without due consideration for a serious personal crisis I am navigating and appears to contravene Queensland Health's policies regarding supportive management and Domestic and Family Violence (DFV) leave.

I am committed to a constructive resolution and trust that your impartial review will facilitate a fair and appropriate outcome. My union representative from Together Heath Moran been copied into the correspondence

Background and Summary of Concerns

The current performance management process stems from a series of procedural and policy failings by management following my confidential disclosure of a personal crisis.

1. Improper Handling of DFV Leave

Request: On March 12, 2025, I confidentially disclosed to Mr. Hughes that I was involved in a complex and traumatic domestic violence situation (involving misrepresentation and disputes over property during separation), as substantiated by court documentation **(Attachment A)**. In accordance with Public Service Commission (PSC) Directive 03/20, I requested access to Domestic and Family Violence Leave **(Attachment B)**. On March 28, 2025, management advised me that as a respondent in the matter, I could be "deemed as the perpetrator" and might be ineligible for leave **(Attachment C)**. This advice is factually incorrect, contravenes the directive, and disregards formal advice I received from the Queensland Police Service, which recommended I seek a protection order for my own safety **(Attachment D)**.

2. Procedural Unfairness and

Misrepresentation: The management approach implemented within the switchboard department has involved punitive performance monitoring, which has proven unproductive given my disclosed difficulties and the adversarial nature of the disclosure. On August 27, 2025, I proactively offered to provide Mr. Hughes' office with relevant documentation to ensure a comprehensive and accurate understanding of my circumstances prior to a scheduled meeting. Immediately following this offer, the meeting was cancelled by his office (**Attachment E**). Subsequently, in his letter initiating the performance plan on September 10, 2025, Mr. Hughes materially misrepresented these events by asserting that my actions were the cause of meetings not proceeding. Ms. Taylor has similarly faced a punitive management approach. (**Attachment F**). A performance process cannot be considered fair or conducted in good faith when an employee's attempts to provide clarifying information are first refused, and that refusal is then used as grounds for punitive action.

3. Inappropriate and Unsupportive

Communication: The pattern of unsupportive management has continued. For instance, on September 29, 2025, shortly after I had finished my shift at 15:00, I received a follow-up email from Chloe, which I have not yet responded to, Ms. Taylor emailed *both* my personal and work email addresses to "follow up to see if I understand the on-call process." This communication felt intrusive and inappropriate, given the timing, the use of my personal email for a routine work query, and the ongoing circumstances. or engaged with, adding to the pressure while I am trying to manage my health and work responsibilities.

The consistent pattern of unsupportive management

remains a concern. On September 29, 2025, immediately after my 3:00 PM shift, I received an intrusive and inappropriate follow-up email from Ms. Taylor. The email, sent to both my personal and work addresses, inquired about my understanding of the on-call process. This communication, particularly its timing and the use of my personal email address, has added to my existing pressure as I manage my health and professional obligations. I have not yet responded to this correspondence.

The cumulative stress from my personal circumstances, compounded by this unsupportive management process, has significantly impacted my well-being. The current performance process unfairly penalizes the symptoms of this crisis rather than addressing the root cause with the support mandated by Queensland Health policy.

Proposed Resolution

To resolve this matter constructively, I respectfully request your assistance with the following:

1. **Immediate suspension of the performance improvement process** to allow for a formal and impartial review of the circumstances leading to its initiation.

2. **An independent review** into management's handling of my confidential disclosure and request for DFV Leave, with specific reference to compliance with PSC Directive 03/20.

3. **A formal audit and correction of my leave balance**, which I believe was improperly coded following my request.

4. **Your appointment as an impartial HR intermediary** to help mediate a fair, supportive, and policy-compliant path forward.

Thank you for your time and attention to this urgent matter. I look forward to your guidance while moving forward in a constructive manner.

Sincerely,

Cory Shepherd